

DOMNA BANAKOU

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Research Profile

Interdisciplinary researcher in HCI and immersive technologies, working at the intersection of experimental psychology, cognitive neuroscience, computer science, and AI-enabled interactive paradigms. My research designs and evaluates immersive systems to understand how technology shapes human behaviour, cognition, social interaction, and wellbeing, with applications in bias and prosocial behaviour, health and rehabilitation, multisensory interaction, and embodied experience.

- Teaching: undergraduate, Master's, Executive MSc, and capstone teaching across Interactive Media, Computer Science, Psychology, and related interdisciplinary programmes.
- Research leadership: research funding; co-established and managed XR Lab; current international collaborations in mixed reality embodiment, rehabilitation, and affective touch.
- Supervision and academic leadership: PhD co-supervision and examination, MSc supervision/mentoring, undergraduate/capstone projects, cross-disciplinary research assistants, editorial roles, and conference leadership.
- Research impact: >4,400 citations (Google Scholar, August 2026), with peer-reviewed work spanning psychology, neuroscience, HCI/XR, and interactive systems.

Education

PhD in Clinical and Health Psychology

University of Barcelona (UB), Spain (2014 – 2017)

Funded by the FI-DGR 2014 Grant for universities and research centres for the recruitment of new research personnel.

MSc in Computer Graphics, Vision and Imaging

University College London (UCL), United Kingdom (2009 – 2010)

BSc in Computer Science

Ionian University, Greece (2004 – 2009)

Academic Appointments & Research Positions

Senior Associate Researcher

LAMPA Arts et Métiers Institute of Technology (October 2025 – present)

- Co-leading international research with the Daisuke Iwai Lab, University of Osaka, on mixed reality embodiment.
- Co-leading collaborations with GETLab, Cyprus University of Technology, on VR stroke rehabilitation, and with CeTI, TU Dresden, on social affective touch in VR.

Visiting Assistant Professor of Interactive Media, Arts & Humanities Division

New York University (NYU) Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates (August 2022 – August 2025)

- Developed and taught core, elective, and capstone courses in virtual reality, game design and programming, web development, and storytelling (IM-UH 2516, IM-UH 2320, IM-UH 1011, IM-UH 4001, CS-UH 4001).
- Co-established and managed the Interactive Media XR Lab and established and ran VR research infrastructure for the Psychology department's Social Roles and Beliefs Lab.
- Secured research funding for VR and cognitive-neuroscience research and supervised/mentored undergraduate and graduate students, PhD students, research assistants, and junior faculty.
- Served on departmental and university committees related to research and academic affairs.

Senior Research Associate

GETLab, Cyprus University of Technology (January 2021 – November 2025)

- Contributed to interdisciplinary VR research in the group led by Dr Despina Michael-Grigoriou, including work in rehabilitation, embodiment, haptics, and social interaction.
- Co-supervised doctoral research and collaborated on peer-reviewed publications and international projects

Research Affiliate

CYENS Centre of Excellence, Nicosia, Cyprus (September 2020 – September 2021)

Designed and co-led research projects in the VR for Well-Being Research Group on the impact of immersive virtual reality on behaviour and cognition.

Assistant Professor of Design, Creation & Multimedia (*part-time*)

Universitat Oberta de Catalunya, Barcelona, Spain (March 2020 – June 2021)

Taught a core Master's course in video game design and programming (M7.458).

Postdoctoral Researcher

Event-Lab, Institute of Neurosciences, University of Barcelona, Spain (May 2017 – July 2022)

Researcher on the ERC Advanced Grant project "Moments in Time in Immersive Virtual Environments (MoTIVE)"; designed and conducted immersive-VR studies and published findings in peer-reviewed journals; contributed to research-funding proposals and international dissemination.

Research Assistant

Event-Lab, Institute of Neurosciences, University of Barcelona, Spain (January 2011 – April 2017)

Worked on the BEinstein project and the EU ICT project VERE (Virtual Embodiment and Robotic Re-Embodiment); designed VR studies, published results, presented internationally, and supervised Master's practicum students.

Research Assistant

University College London (UCL), London, UK (May 2010 – Sept 2010)

Participated in a Leverhulme Trust project on immersive VR and moral judgements; designed a study on emotion and moral behaviour and presented the results internationally.

Additional Teaching Experience

Guest Lecturer, The London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE), London, UK (June 2021, June 2022)

Executive MSc Behavioural Science, Virtual Reality in Psychology

Seminar Lecturer, Universitat Pompeu Fabra (UPF), Barcelona, Spain (Fall 2020)

MSc in Brain and Cognition, Department of Information and Communication Technologies, Experimental research in virtual reality

Seminar Lecturer, Universitat de Barcelona (UB), Barcelona, Spain (Fall 2014, 2015)

MSc Interactive Physiology, Faculty of Biology, Experimental research in virtual reality – theory and technology

Supervision & Academic Engagement

Doctoral Supervision and Mentorship

- **Co-supervisor**, Christos Hadjipanayi, Department of Multimedia and Graphic Arts, Cyprus University of Technology (2022–2026). Topic: *Virtual reality with social co-presence for rehabilitation.*
- **Co-supervisor**, Ali Najm, Department of Multimedia and Graphic Arts, Cyprus University of Technology (2022–Ongoing). Topic: *Enhancing the Sense of embodiment in VR.*
- **Advisor Committee**, Matilde Tassinari, Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Helsinki, Finland (2022–2024). Topic: *Navigating Prejudice in Virtual Reality: Direct, Indirect, and Secondary Transfer Effects of Positive and Negative Intergroup Contact in VR.*
- **Mentor**, Lisa Izzouzi, University College London, UK (2022–2023). Topic: *Virtual Emerging Leadership.*

Master's, Undergraduate, and Research Mentoring

- **Co-supervisor**, Lucile Bottein, MSc Cognitive Neuroscience, University College London, UK. Principal Supervisor: Dr. Aneesha Singh (2022-2023). Topic: *Modelling Changes in Implicit Racial Bias after an Immersive Virtual Reality Experience*.
- **Mentor**, Rachel Bedder, Brain and Mind Sciences MSc, University College London, UK. Principal Supervisor: Dr. Neil Burgess and Dr. Dan Bush (2017-2018). Topic: *Asymmetries Between Gains and Losses in Mood and Decision Making*.
- **Supervisor/ Co-Supervisor**, 17 undergraduate and capstone projects across Interactive Media and Computer Science; mentored 8 research assistants across Interactive Media, Computer Science, Political Science, and Psychology.

PhD Examination and Committees

- **Thesis Examiner**, Dr. Cory A. Logston, Media Psychology, Fielding Graduate University, California, USA (January 2024). Topic: *The effects of historical empathy and transformative learning on implicit bias in a virtual reality experience*; Dr. Brett Parton, School of Applied Psychology, Griffith University, Australia (August 2024). Topic: *An Investigation of Key Factors in the Viability and Effectiveness of Virtual Reality Exposure Therapy for the Fear of Public Speaking*; Dr. Wanxian Zeng, Research School of Management at The Australian National University, Australia (June 2021). Topic: *Adding Dimension to Content: Immersive Virtual Reality and Presence for e-Commerce*.
- **Thesis Defense Secretary**, Dr. Judith Guadalupe Ley Flores, Science and Information Technology, Universidad Carlos III Madrid, Spain (September 2022). Topic: *Using movement sonification to alter body perception and promote physical activity in physically inactive*; Dr. Mila Bujić, of Information Technology and Communication Sciences. Tampere University, Finland (July 2021). Topic: *Immersive Persuasiveness: Investigating media effects of 360-degree immersive journalism*; Dr. Marina Scattolin, Psychology & Social Neuroscience Sapienza University, Italy (April 2021). Topic: *How the sense of body ownership shapes honesty: Evidence from behavioural, clinical and immersive virtual reality studies*.

Research Funding, Awards & Leadership

Principal Investigator research funding

- Tamkeen Research Grant, UAE (2024), US\$15,000, PI Project: VR experiences to study human responses in economic games.
- Tamkeen Research Grant, UAE (2023), US\$15,000, PI Project: VR-based intervention in art and rehabilitation.
- Tamkeen Research Grant, UAE (2022), US\$15,000, PI Project: VR experiences to study implicit biases.
- NYU Faculty Advancement Grant, UAE (2024), US\$4,500, additional support for independent research development.
- NYU Institute Events Sponsorship, UAE (2023), US\$14,000, public events, workshops, and conferences hosted at NYU Abu Dhabi.

Selected Awards and Scholarships

FENS-IBRO/PERC Travel Grant Berlin, 2018; SIGGRAPH European Contest Grant IST Austria, 2016; Eurolife Grant - Summer School "Emotions" Innsbruck, 2015; "Best Young Researcher" Award University of Barcelona, 2015; FI-DGR Grant for universities and research centres for the recruitment of new research personnel Spain, 2014; Ionian University Award of Program in Informatics Greece, 2009; IKY (Greek State Scholarships Foundation) Award & Scholarship Greece 2009; IKY; IKY 2007; IKY 2006.

Selected Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

[Virtual Counterclockwise: Being Embodied as Their Younger Self in Virtual Reality and Revisiting a Past Iconic Event May Improve Cognitive and Physical Performance of the Aged: A Between-Groups Study](#)

Banakou D., Itatani R., Montserrat R., Porta-Mas C., Bartrés-Faz D., Bodner E., Mataro M., Slater M. (2026). *JMIR Form Res* 2026;10:e88338. doi:10.2196/88338

[Social facilitation within immersive virtual reality enhances perseverance in stroke rehabilitation training](#)

Hadjipanayi C., Sokratous D., Kyrlitsias C., Banakou D., Michael-Grigoriou D. (2025). *Frontiers in Virtual Reality*, 6:1581240. doi: 10.3389/frvir.2025.1581240

[Multisensory experiences of affective touch in virtual reality enhance engagement, body ownership, pleasantness, and arousal modulation](#)

Sun W., Banakou D., Świdrak J., Valori I., Slater M., Fairhurst M.T.(2024). *Virtual Reality* 28, 162.doi:10.1007/s10055-024-01056-2.

[Development of a Modular Adjustable Wearable Haptic Device for XR Applications](#)

Najm, A., Banakou, D., Michael-Grigoriou, D. (2024). *Virtual Worlds*, 3, 436-458. doi:10.3390/virtualworlds3040024.

[Desensitizing Anxiety Through Imperceptible Change: Feasibility Study on a Paradigm for Single-Session Exposure Therapy for Fear of Public Speaking](#)

Banakou D., Johnston T., Beacco A., Senel G., Slater M. (2024). *JMIR Formative Research* 2024;8:e52212. doi: 10.2196/52212.

[Haptic feedback in a virtual crowd scenario improves the emotional response](#)

Venkatesan R.K., Banakou D., Slater M., Manivannan M. (2023). *Frontiers in Virtual Reality – Haptics*, 4:1242587. doi:10.3389/frvir.2023.1242587.

[A comparison of two methods for moving through a virtual environment: walking in place and interactive redirected walking](#)

Banakou D., Slater M. (2023). *Frontiers in Virtual Reality – Virtual Reality and Human Behaviour*, 4:1294539. doi:10.3389/frvir.2023.1294539.

[Using virtual reality to assess gesture performance deficits in schizophrenia patients](#)

Pavlidou A., Gorisse G., Banakou D., Walther S. (2023). *Frontiers in Psychiatry*, 14:1191601. doi:10.3389/fpsy.2023.1191601.

[The sentiment of a virtual rock concert](#)

Slater, M., Cabriera, C., Senel, G. Banakou D., Beacco A., Oliva R., Gallego J. (2023). *Virtual Reality* 27, 651–675. doi:10.1007/s10055-022-00685-9.

[A Separate Reality: An Update on Place Illusion and Plausibility in Virtual Reality](#)

Slater M., Banakou D., Beacco A., Gallego J., Macia-Varela, R Oliva M. (2022). *Frontiers in Virtual Reality* 3:914392. doi:10.3389/frvir.2022.914392.

[The Golden Rule as a Paradigm for Fostering Prosocial Behavior with Virtual Reality](#)

Slater M., Banakou D. (2021). *Current Directions in Psychological Science*. 30(6), 503-509. doi:10.1177/09637214211046954.

[Evaluating participant responses to a virtual reality experience using reinforcement learning](#)

Llobera, J., Beacco, A., Oliva, R., Şenel, G., Banakou, D., Slater, M. (2021). *Royal Society Open Science*, 8: 210537. doi:10.1098/rsos.210537.

[Virtual body ownership and its consequences for implicit racial bias are dependent on social context](#)

Banakou D., Beacco A., Neyret S., Blasco-Oliver M., Seinfeld S., Slater M. (2020). *Royal Society Open Science*, 7:201848. doi: 10.1098/rsos.201848.

[Exploring the Effect of Cooperation in Reducing Implicit Racial Bias and Its Relationship With Dispositional Empathy and Political Attitudes](#)

Patané, I., Lelgouarch, A., Banakou, D., Verdelet, G., Desoche, C., Koun, E., Salemme, R., Slater, M., Farnè, A. (2020). *Frontiers in Psychology*, 11:510787. doi: 10.3389/fpsyg.2020.510787.

[Social Conformity in Immersive Virtual Environments: The Impact of Agents' Gaze Behavior](#)

Kyrlitsias, C., Michael-Grigoriou, D., Banakou, D., Christofi, M. (2020). *Frontiers in Psychology*, 11:2254. doi: 10.3389/fpsyg.2020.02254.

A mechanistic account of bodily resonance and implicit bias

Bedder, R.L., Bush, D., Banakou, D., Peck, T., Slater, M., Burgess, N. (2019). *Cognition* 184, 1-10. doi: 10.1016/j.cognition.2018.11.010.

Virtually Being Einstein Results in an Improvement in Cognitive Task Performance and a Decrease in Age Bias

Banakou, D., Kishore S., Slater M. (2018). *Frontiers in Psychology*, 9(917). doi: 10.3389/fpsyg.2018.00917.

Reducing risk and improving maternal perspective-taking and empathy using virtual embodiment

Hamilton-Giachritsis, C., Banakou, D., Quiroga, M.G., Giachritsis C., Slater, M. (2018). *Scientific Reports*, 8(1). doi: 10.1038/s41598-018-21036-2.

Embodiment in a virtual body that speaks produces agency over the speaking but does not necessarily influence subsequent real speaking

Banakou, D., & Slater, M. (2017). *Scientific Reports*, 7(1). doi: 10.1038/s41598-017-14620-5.

Embodiment in a Child-Like Talking Virtual Body Influences Object Size Perception, Self-Identification, and Subsequent Real Speaking

Tajadura-Jiménez, A., Banakou, D., Bianchi-Berthouze, N., Slater, M. (2017). *Scientific Reports*, 7, 9637 (2017). doi: 10.1038/s41598-017-09497-3.

Embodiment of White People in a Black Virtual Body Leads to a Sustained Reduction in their Implicit Racial Bias

Banakou D., Parasuram D. H., & Slater M. (2016). *Frontiers in Human Neuroscience*, 10 (601). doi: 10.3389/fnhum.2016.00601.

Body ownership causes illusory self-attribution of speaking and influences subsequent real speaking

Banakou, D., & Slater, M. (2014). *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences (PNAS)*, 111, 17678–17683. doi: 10.1073/pnas.1414936111.

Illusory ownership of a virtual child body causes overestimation of object sizes and implicit attitude changes

Banakou, D., Groten, R. & Slater M. (2013). *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences (PNAS)*, 1 (6), 12846–12851. Doi: 10.1073/pnas.130677911.

Conference papers

A Virtual Reality Stroop Art Exergame for Cognitive-Motor Rehabilitation in Chronic Stroke Survivors

Hadjipanayi, C., Banakou, D., Azhar, A., Sokratous, D., Michael-Grigoriou, D. (2025). In K. Helin, B. Schiavi, & E. Tsaknaki (Eds.), *EuroXR 2025: Proceedings of the Application, Poster, and Demo Tracks of the 22nd EuroXR International Conference (VTT Technology No. 440)*. VTT Technical Research Centre of Finland. <https://doi.org/10.32040/2242-122X.2025.T440>

Adaptive Virtual Reality Meditation for Adults with ADHD

Zhagufarova, A., Banakou, D., Salam, H. (2026). In: Brooks, A.L., Banakou, D., Ceperkovic, S. (eds) *ArtsIT, Interactivity and Game Creation. ArtsIT 2024. Lecture Notes of the Institute for Computer Sciences, Social Informatics and Telecommunications Engineering*, vol 651. Springer, Cham. <https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-97257-7>

Tapping into Touch Preferences and Individual Behaviours: Assessing and Improving the HandsOn Mobile App

Fairhurst, M.T., Sun, W., Hadjipanayi, C., Michael-Grigoriou, D., Banakou, D. (2026). In: Brooks, A.L., Banakou, D., Ceperkovic, S. (eds) *ArtsIT, Interactivity and Game Creation. ArtsIT 2024. Lecture Notes of the Institute for Computer Sciences, Social Informatics and Telecommunications Engineering*, vol 651. Springer, Cham. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-97257-7_10

vER: Virtual Human Companionship for Patients in Preoperative Care

Pandhare A., Skulikj D., Lee J., Mikhie P., Banakou D. (2025). In *Proceedings of the 2025 ACM International Conference on Interactive Media Experiences (IMX '25)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 468–472. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3706370.3731639>

The virtual touch toolkit: An interactive media mobile application for promoting well-being through affective and social touch

Najm, A., Hadjipanayi, C., Michael-Grigoriou, D., Banakou, D., McGlone, F., Fairhurst, M. (2022). *2nd International Conference on Interactive Media, Smart Systems and Emerging Technologies, IMET 2022, Limassol 4 October 2022*, 183954, 1-4. doi: 10.1109/IMET54801.2022.9929934.

Books Chapters

Virtual Reality in Stroke Rehabilitation and Treatment: Focusing on the Patient's Experience and Needs

Hadjipanayi, C., Banakou, D., Michael-Grigoriou, D. (2025). In: Charalambous, A. (eds) Critical Perspectives on Technological Innovations in Healthcare. Springer, Cham. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-87158-0_7

Editorials and Commentaries

[Beyond audiovisual: novel multisensory stimulation techniques and their applications](#)

Świdrak, J., Georgiou, O., Banakou, D., Matamala-Gomez, M., Pochwatko, G., Seinfeld, S. (2024). *Frontiers in Virtual Reality*, 5:1491854. doi: 10.3389/frvir.2024.1491854.

[The light and dark sides of virtual reality](#)

Oberdörfer, S., Banakou, D., Bhargava, A. (2023). *Frontiers in Virtual Reality*, 4:1200156. doi: 10.3389/frvir.2023.1200156

[Being Somebody Else: The Future of Narrative Storytelling](#)

Banakou, D., Hadjipanayi, C. (2022). *View: Theories & Practices of Visual Culture/Widok: Teorie I Praktyki* (33). doi: 10.36854/widok/2022.33.2570

[Neuropsychological and Cognitive-Behavioral Assessment of Neurodegenerative Disease and Rehabilitation Using New Technologies and Virtual Reality](#)

Matamala-Gomez, M., Stasolla, F., Seinfeld, S., Caffò, A.O., Banakou, D., Bottiroli, S. (2021). *Frontiers in Psychology*, 12:691909. doi: 10.3389/fpsyg.2021.691909

Selected Keynote & Invited Talks

[Symposia XI: Social Interaction as Transdiagnostic Challenge in Psychiatry](#), 17th World Congress of Biological Psychiatry (WFSBP), Berlin, Germany, 9-12 September 2025 (**invited speaker**).

[Expo Osaka 2025](#), Virtual Reality to Transform Behaviour, Exhibition at UAE Pavillion: Peace, Human Security and Dignity, Osaka, Kansai, Japan, 8-12 August 2025 (**keynote speaker**).

[How Artificial Character Embodiment shapes user behaviour in multi-modal interactions Workshop](#), 25th International Conference on Multimodal Interaction, Paris, France, 13 October 2023 (**keynote speaker**).

[Enhancing Prosocial Behavior in VR](#), Würtual Reality XR-Meeting, Würzburg, Germany, 11 April 2023 (**keynote speaker**).

[Embodiment for a Kinder Society](#), The Czech Transformative Tech Community, Deloitte, RedButton Edu and pAloneers, Czech Republic (Online), 16 June 2022 (**keynote speaker**).

[VR in Healthcare and Rehabilitation](#), Universitäre Psychiatrische Dienste Bern, Bern, Switzerland, 5 June 2022 (**invited speaker**).

[How to Overcome the Body](#), VACZINE ART Symposium, Düsseldorf (Online), Germany, 4 Jul 2021 (**keynote speaker**).

[Immersive Virtual Reality: Technology, Concepts, and Multisensory Integration](#), The Active Self Autumn School I, Herrsching, Germany, Oct 2019 (**invited speaker**).

[Being Somebody Else: The Future of Narrative Storytelling](#), Filmteractive 2019, Lodz, Poland, Oct 2019 (**keynote speaker**).

[Virtual Body Representation Can Change the Self](#), Integrative Science Symposium: How Changing Our Bodies changes Our Selves, 3rd Biennial International Convention of Psychological Science, Paris, France, Mar 2019 (**keynote speaker**).

Selected Media Coverage & Public Engagement

[NHK Japan Broadcasting Corporation](#) "Frontiers – The World is Made of Illusions" by Joe Odagiri and Yu Aoi – Featured research in Japanese documentary series exploring virtual reality's role in ownership illusions and behavioural changes. (October 31, 2024)

[Popular Mechanics](#) "The VR 'Proteus Effect' Explained" by Sarah Wells – Insights provided on how virtual avatars can influence user behaviour and identity. (October 16, 2023)

[Epsilon Magazine \(printed version only\)](#) "Effect Proteus – Le Pouvoir des Avatars" by Muriel Valin – Featured research in French article exploring the role of avatars in behavioural change. (October 9, 2023)

[APS Observer](#) "Mind Over Body" by Alexandra Michel – Article highlighting research on body ownership illusions in virtual reality. (March 24, 2020)

[ERT \(Greek National Television\)](#) "Virtual reality and the sense of embodiment" by Eve Tsirigotaki – Greek article featured in a segment on the psychological effects of virtual reality. (November 21, 2019)

[The Psychologist](#) "Shattering the self" – Discussed the contradictory nature of the self in virtual environments. (July 1, 2019)

[BBC Click](#) "Virtual lives: Could VR change how we think of others?" – Featured in a segment discussing the impact of virtual reality on empathy and social perception. (October 11, 2018)

[The New Yorker](#) "Are we already living in virtual reality?" by Joshua Rothman – Contribution to an article exploring the philosophical implications of immersive virtual environments. (March 26, 2018)

["Bias" Documentary](#) Directed by Robin Hauser – Featured in a documentary film exploring implicit biases and virtual reality's role in addressing them. (2018)

[Big Think](#) "People who embody Albert Einstein in VR perform better on cognitive tasks" by Stephen Johnson – Coverage of studies showing cognitive enhancement through virtual embodiment. (July 11, 2018)

[Science Daily](#) "Seeing yourself as Einstein may change the way you think" – Coverage of findings on virtual embodiment and cognitive performance. (July 9, 2018)

[The New Yorker](#) "This is your avatar speaking" by Nicola Twilley – Interviewed about research on virtual embodiment and its effects on self-perception. (February 20, 2015)

[BBC Science](#) "Can virtual reality be used to tackle racism?" by Melissa Hogenboom – Contribution to a science article covering how VR can be used to tackle racism. (November 28, 2013)

Academic & Professional Service

Professional Memberships

Full Member (by nomination only), Sigma Xi The Scientific Research Honor Society (2024–Present). Nominated by Jamie L. Vernon, PhD, Executive Director and CEO Sigma Xi for showing noteworthy achievement as an original investigator in a field of pure or applied science; *Professional Member*, Association for Computing Machinery (ACM) (2024–Present); *Individual Member*, EuroXR Association (2024–Present); *Fellow Recognition*, European Alliance for Innovation (2024–Present). Honoured for exceptional contributions and leadership in engineering and technology and significantly advancing the field, impacting both academia and industry internationally.

Editorial Leadership

- **Assistant Specialty Chief Editor**, Frontiers in Virtual Reality, Topics: Virtual Reality and Behaviour.
- **Academic Editor**, PLOS One. Topics: Psychology - Cognitive psychology, Neuroscience - Behavioral and cognitive, Computer and information sciences - Human-Computer interactions.
- **Guest Associate Editor**, Frontiers in Psychology. Topics: Personality and Social Psychology, Neuropsychology.
- **Review Editor**, Frontiers in Virtual Reality; Frontiers in Psychology.
- **Research Topics Editor**, Frontiers in Virtual Reality; Frontiers in Psychology; Frontiers in Robotics and AI; MDPI Virtual Worlds.

Peer Review

Journal reviewer for Frontiers in Psychology, Frontiers in Robotics and AI, Frontiers in Virtual Reality, Frontiers in Human Neuroscience, PLOS ONE, Scientific Reports, Virtual Reality, The Arts in Psychotherapy, Computers in Human Behavior Reports, Digital Health, and Journal of Clinical Medicine. Conference/jury reviewing includes CHI, IEEE VR, ISMAR, VRST, DIS, CSCW, CHI PLAY, IMX, ACII, SAP, ISEA, CASA, MXR, and Laval Virtual.

Conference Leadership

- **General Co-Chair, Program Co-Chair**, EAI ArtsIT 2026, 15th International Conference on ArtsIT, Interactivity, and Game Creation, Bratislava, Slovakia (Dec 2026).
- **General Chair, Program Chair, Local Chair**, EAI ArtsIT 2024, 13th International Conference on ArtsIT, Interactivity, and Game Creation, NYU Abu Dhabi, UAE (Nov 2024).
- **General Chair**, 2nd Virtual Embodiment and Robotic Re-Embodiment (VERE) PhD Symposium, Barcelona, Spain (2014).
- **General Co-Chair, Organizing Committee**, 1st Institute for Brain, Cognition and Behavior (IR3C) PhD Symposium, Barcelona, Spain (Oct 2015).

- **Applications Track Co-Chair**, 21st EuroXR 2024 International Conference, Athens, Greece (Nov 2024).
- **Demo Track Co-Chair**, ICAT-EGVE 2018, 28th International Conference on Artificial Reality and Telexistence Limassol, Cyprus (Nov 2018).
- **Program Committee Member**, VRST 2025, *Montreal, Canada*; VRST 2023, *Christchurch, New Zealand*; MELECON 2016, *Limassol, Cyprus*; AIVR 2020, *Online*.

Referees

- **Prof. Mel Slater**
Distinguished Investigator at the University of Barcelona, and co-Director of the Event Lab (Experimental Virtual Environments for Neuroscience and Technology)
melslater@ub.edu (+34 93 403 9618)
- **Dr. Ana Tajadura Jiménez**
Associate Professor at Universidad Carlos III de Madrid
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